

Zhengxiang Wang

 [LinkedIn](#)

 zhengxiang-wang.me

 zhengxiang.wang@stonybrook.edu

Education

2022–present	Ph.D. in Computational Linguistics Stony Brook University Advisor: Owen Rambow	Stony Brook, NY
2019–2021	M.A. in Applied Linguistics University of Saskatchewan Advisor: Zhi Li	Saskatoon, Canada
2015–2019	B.A. in Chinese Language and Literature Hunan University	Changsha, China

Industry Experience

Aug 2025–Jan 2026	Applied Scientist Intern Amazon , Alexa AI (Central Analytics & Research Science)	Boston, MA
	- Post-trained large audio language models for device-directed user satisfaction prediction. - Authored a manuscript on mitigating the modality gap through task-specific fine-tuning.	
May 2025–Aug 2025	Software Engineer, Machine Learning Intern Meta , Feed Ranking	Bellevue, WA
	Developed a production-facing LVLM-based agentic workflow in PHP/Hack for trend detection, validation, magnitude labeling, and content quality rating.	
May 2024–Aug 2024	Data Scientist Intern The Home Depot	Hybrid (NY Atlanta, GA)
	Developed LLM-powered topic modeling, classification, and validation systems to surface customer pain points and generate actionable insights.	

Publications

Personal Agents; Long-Horizon Tasks

2026 (Under Review) Weizhi Zhang, Wei-Chieh Huang, Yueqing Liang, Liwei Jiang, **Zhengxiang Wang**, [51 authors omitted], Kai Shu, Xue Liu, & Philip S. Yu, **JARVIS-Bench: Benchmarking Personal Intelligence Agents on Long-Horizon Real-User Daily Traces**.

Multi-Turn (Interactive) Visual Grounding; Human-AI Interaction

2026 (Under Review) **Wang, Z.** & Rambow, O. **When Seeing Is Not Enough: Benchmarking Interactive Visual Grounding in LVLMs**.

ACL 2026 Oral Zeng, P., Li, W., Paige, A., **Wang, Z.**, Kaliosis, P., Samaras, D., Zelinsky, G., Brennan, S., & Rambow, O., **LVLMs and Humans Ground Differently in Referential Communication**.

EMNLP 2025 Main **Wang, Z.**, Li, W., Kaliosis, P., Rambow, O., & Brennan, S., **LVLMs are Bad at Overhearing Human Referential Communication**.

Personalized Writing Assessment & Imitation

EMNLP 2025 Findings	Wang, Z. , Tripto, N., Park, S., Li, Z., & Zhou, J., Catch Me If You Can? Not Yet: LLMs Still Struggle to Imitate the Implicit Writing Styles of Everyday Authors.
ACL 2025	Wang, Z. , Makarova, V., Li, Z., Kodner, J., & Rambow, O., LLMs can Perform Multi-Dimensional Analytic Writing Assessments: A Case Study of L2 Graduate-Level Academic English Writing.
Frontiers in Communication 2023	Li, Z., Makarova, V., & Wang, Z. , 2023, Developing Literature Review Writing Skills through an Online Writing Tutorial Series: Corpus-based Evidence.

Post-Training: Audio Language Models

2026 (Under Review)	Wang, Z. , Cogill, R., Nayyeri, H., Gopinath, C., & Hari, T. Exploring the Modality Gap in LALMs via Task-Specific Fine-Tuning
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Multi-Step Reasoning

2026 (Under Review)	Wang, Z. , & Dong, Z., Measuring Iterative Temporal Reasoning with Time Puzzles.
GEM ² @ACL 2025	Wang, Z. , Kodner, J., & Rambow, O., Evaluating LLMs with Multiple Problems at Once.
Insights Workshop @ NAACL 2025	Wang, Z. , Kodner, J., & Rambow, O., Exploring Limitations of LLM Capabilities with Multi-Problem Evaluation.

Traditional NLP

Springer 2023	Wang, Z. , Probabilistic Linguistic Knowledge and Token-level Text Augmentation , In <i>Practical Solutions for Diverse Real-World NLP Applications</i> .
ICGI 2023	Wang, Z. , Learning Transductions and Alignments with RNN Seq2seq Models , <i>Proceedings of Machine Learning Research</i> , Vol. 217.
VIS/TVCG 2022	Hao, H., Cui, Y., Wang, Z. , & Kim, Y., Thirty-Two Years of IEEE VIS: Authors, Fields of Study and Citations , <i>IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics</i> .

Skills & Service

Programming	Python, Hack/PHP, R, Bash, SQL, L ^A T _E X, HTML, Markdown
ML / NLP	Transformers, PyTorch, TensorFlow, vLLM, LlamaFactory, NumPy, Pandas, scikit-learn
Reviewing	EMNLP 2026, ACL 2026/2025, ARR March 2026, COLING 2025

Awards & Honors

2024	IACS Junior Researcher Award (\$37,000)
2023	NSF BIAS-NRT Research Traineeship
2023	SBU Distinguished Travel Award (\$1,750)
2019	Globalink Graduate Fellowship (\$15,000)
2018	Chinese Government Scholarship (\$7,000)
2017	Chinese National Student Innovation Training Program Grant (¥10,000)
2016	Chinese National Scholarship (¥8,000)